

SENATE RESOLUTION 344

By Seal

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend SafeSpace on the occasion of its fiftieth anniversary.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this legislative body should pay tribute to those exemplary institutions that work with purpose and conviction to protect the well-being of Tennessee's citizens and strengthen their communities; and

WHEREAS, SafeSpace is one such outstanding organization, which is marking fifty years of dedicated service assisting victims of domestic violence and their children in East Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, SafeSpace began in 1976 as a grassroots effort when a network of women in the mountainous Appalachian region of East Tennessee opened their homes to shelter victims of domestic violence and their children, demonstrating compassion and courage in addressing a critical need within their communities; and

WHEREAS, this early effort soon evolved into the Cosby Coalition Against Domestic Violence, which organized formally in 1979 and incorporated as a nonprofit charitable organization in 1981, thereby establishing a structured and sustainable response to domestic violence in the region; and

WHEREAS, in 1983, SafeSpace secured office space in the City Hall of Newport and hired its first staff members, marking an important step toward expanding services to victims in need; and

WHEREAS, on June 25, 1985, the organization opened its first shelter, providing refuge and safety to women and children fleeing abusive situations, and the shelter has remained an essential resource for victims of domestic violence ever since; and

WHEREAS, SafeSpace has been an integral part of the movement to end domestic violence in Tennessee and was among the founding members of the Tennessee Coalition Against Domestic and Sexual Violence; and

WHEREAS, the organization also played a historic role in securing the first rural order of protection in the State of Tennessee and has since become widely regarded as a model for rural shelter services; and

WHEREAS, through its emergency shelter, crisis intervention services, counseling, court advocacy, resource referrals, and educational outreach, SafeSpace has provided critical support to countless individuals and families seeking safety and stability; and

WHEREAS, guided by its mission to end domestic violence by supporting and empowering victims while educating the community, SafeSpace continues to work tirelessly to promote awareness, prevention, and healing for those affected by abuse; and

WHEREAS, the continued success of SafeSpace is due, in large measure, to the dedication and compassion of its staff, volunteers, and supporters, whose tireless efforts have provided safety, advocacy, and hope to individuals and families in need; and

WHEREAS, through its many programs and services, SafeSpace has played a vital role in promoting safety, stability, and healing for victims of domestic violence while strengthening families and communities throughout the region; and

WHEREAS, for fifty years, the dedicated staff, volunteers, and supporters of SafeSpace have demonstrated compassion, perseverance, and a steadfast commitment to protecting vulnerable individuals and strengthening the communities they serve; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor and commend SafeSpace upon the occasion of its fiftieth anniversary and extend our appreciation to its

leadership, staff, volunteers, and supporters for their many years of dedicated service to victims of domestic violence and their families.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.